

Inspection of Church Preen Pre-School

Church Preen Village Hall, Church Preen, Church Stretton, Shropshire SY6 7LH

Inspection date: 4 June 2024

Overall effectiveness	Good
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The quality of education	Good
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Behaviour and attitudes	Good
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Personal development	Good
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Leadership and management	Good
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Overall effectiveness at previous inspection	Good
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What is it like to attend this early years setting?

The provision is good

The manager provides children with a wide range of learning experiences that complement and build on what children learn at home. Staff take time to get to know children, their families and home lives so they can enrich the learning for each child. They have created a play environment that reflects the seven areas of learning and provides quality invitations to play and learn. Children are happy and well motivated and choose whether they will play indoors or outdoors. They decide to engage in independent play or with their friends.

The manager places a strong focus on supporting children's independence as part of the curriculum. Staff encourage children to manage their self-care routines. This includes removing outdoor clothes, washing their hands and getting themselves ready for staff to change their nappy or clothing. When staff start preparing for snack time, two-year-old children know they must go to wash their hands and do so without being prompted.

Staff have high expectations for children's behaviour, and children know what they need to do during the various routines throughout the day. Older children understand what is right and wrong. They remind the younger children of the rules, such as being sensible while they wash their hands, and seek support from staff to help younger children understand about sharing the resources.

What does the early years setting do well and what does it need to do better?

- The manager reflects effectively on staff practice and the service they provide. She works with the committee to develop action plans to further enhance children's education experiences. Recently, they have been extending the provision for children's outdoor learning.
- The manager monitors staff practice and provides them with effective supervision, guidance and training to help them continuously progress their knowledge and skills. Staff have recently accessed the Department for Education's training initiatives to support their mathematical teaching.
- Overall, staff provide children with good models to support their language development. They provide frequent opportunities for children to engage with books and sing songs and rhymes. Children build up a wide repertoire of action songs. However, the manager and staff do not focus as well as possible on providing two-year-old children with precise support for their speaking and language development. This means that the teaching for some younger children is not matched precisely to their specific language need, to help them make the best possible progress.
- The manager and staff monitor children's progress effectively. Overall, they plan well for children's learning. They take account of children's interests to plan the

learning experiences so that children are engaged in purposeful play. However, the manager and staff do not identify how they can match their teaching to the needs of all children during large-group times. At times, staff do not offer the highest level of challenge for some older children and occasionally pitch activities too high for some of the two-year-old children.

- The provision for children with special educational needs and/or disabilities (SEND) is effective. The special educational needs coordinator (SENCo) liaises with parents and outside agencies so children benefit from the support they need.
- The manager ensures that children's emotional development is supported through the curriculum. Staff help children to regulate their feelings. This involves learning breathing techniques and controlling their body movements through stretching and balancing exercises. Two-year-old children understand that it is reasonable to return a toy when another child was already playing with it.
- Staff help children to develop their concentration skills and to find solutions to problems. For example, older children sustain their focus as they create boats using recycled materials. They decide whether their boat should have a mast and sail or oars for rowing and select appropriate resources to achieve their design ideas.
- The indoor and outdoor learning environments are both well designed to support children's physical development. Children develop a sense of risk as they use climbing equipment. Staff set up writing opportunities on a variety of angles to support a wide range of upper body movements, such as painting on vertical surfaces or kneeling to write.
- Partnerships with parents are strong. Staff keep parents frequently updated about their child's progress. This includes offering guidance to support children's learning at home. Parents and grandparents speak positively about the service provided. They report how their children are well prepared for when they start school, especially with their independence and social skills.

Safeguarding

The arrangements for safeguarding are effective.

There is an open and positive culture around safeguarding that puts children's interests first.

What does the setting need to do to improve?

To further improve the quality of the early years provision, the provider should:

- extend the language teaching strategies to help accelerate the progress for all two-year-old children
- review planning of large-group activities so that teaching is matched precisely to

the wide variety of children's stages of development.

Setting details

Unique reference number	EY345881
Local authority	Shropshire
Inspection number	10350488
Type of provision	Childcare on non-domestic premises
Registers	Early Years Register
Day care type	Sessional day care
Age range of children at time of inspection	2 to 4
Total number of places	20
Number of children on roll	11
Name of registered person	Church Preen Pre-School Committee
Registered person unique reference number	RP526704
Telephone number	01694771797
Date of previous inspection	15 October 2018

Information about this early years setting

Church Preen Pre-School registered in 2007. The pre-school employs three members of childcare staff, all of whom hold appropriate early years qualifications at level 3. The pre-school opens on Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday from 9am to 3pm, during term time only. The pre-school provides funded early education for two-, three- and four-year-old children.

Information about this inspection

Inspector

Anne Dyoss

Inspection activities

- This was the first routine inspection the provider received since the COVID-19 pandemic began. The inspector discussed the impact of the pandemic with the provider and has taken that into account in their evaluation of the provider.
- The inspector viewed the provision and discussed the safety and suitability of the premises.
- The manager joined the inspector on a learning walk and talked to the inspector about their curriculum and what they want their children to learn.
- Children interacted with the inspector during the inspection.
- The inspector talked to staff at appropriate times during the inspection and took account of their views.
- The SENCo spoke to the inspector about how they support children with SEND.
- The inspector carried out a joint observation of a group activity with the manager.
- Parents and grandparents shared their views of the setting with the inspector.
- The inspector looked at relevant documentation and reviewed evidence of the suitability of staff working in the pre-school.

We carried out this inspection under sections 49 and 50 of the Childcare Act 2006 on the quality and standards of provision that is registered on the Early Years Register. The registered person must ensure that this provision complies with the statutory framework for children's learning, development and care, known as the early years foundation stage.

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